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System and method for equalizing output power of a repeater

Abstract

A repeater, and method of operating the same, for receiving and boosting signals from a plurality of mobile network operators. The repeater includes a donor antenna for receiving a composite signal that comprises separate signals from two or more of the plurality of mobile network operators, each of the separate signals having an amplitude. The repeater further includes an amplitude equalizer configured to equalize the amplitude of each of the separate signals of the composite signal, and an amplifier configured to boost the composite signal. The repeater further includes a server antenna for transmitting the boosted composite signal with the equalized separate signals.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) Wireless repeaters may be used to boost signals, such as cellular signals, in order to resolve problems with poor coverage. One type of repeater is commonly referred to as a wideband repeater as this type of repeater has a passband that is typically wider than the bandwidth of the signal of one wanted signal. An example of where such a repeater may be used is in a cellular network where two or more mobile network operators may be transmitting signals in the same frequency band (e.g., 3GPP Band 1) and the signals from the two or more operators needs to be boosted.

(2) FIG. 1 shows the basic structure of a wideband repeater **100**. Actual implementations may vary. A signal is received from via the donor antenna **102**. This signal is typically a composite signal received from a number of different mobile network operator signals. The input signals may be filtered using an input bandpass filter **104** after which the signals are amplified using a low-noise power amplifier **106**. Following this initial amplification stage, one or more additional amplification stages **108** may be present to boost the signal to a specific level. The final signal may be filtered prior by filter **110** for transmission via the server antenna **112**.

(3) A fundamental problem with a wideband repeater is that any imbalance in the input signal levels from the different operators will be reflected in the output as well. This means that the smaller signal on the input will be the smaller signal on the output which in turns means that the coverage footprint that is created by the repeater for the mobile network operator with the smaller signal will be smaller than the coverage footprint created for the mobile network operator with the larger signal. This is in fact the opposite of the optimal outcome which would be that all operator signals at the output of the repeater should be similar in magnitude.

SUMMARY

(4) This document describes a system and method for equalizing output power of a repeater. In one aspect, a repeater is described having a passband that is wider than the signal of a single mobile network operator and includes an amplitude equalizer and an amplitude equalizer control system. The amplitude equalizer control system receives information on the input signal strength of wanted

signals and controls the amplitude equalizer to counteract the difference in input amplitude on the output of the repeater. The input information can be generated by cellular modem. In some implementations, the amplitude equalizer control system executes an adaptive amplitude equalizer algorithm to equalize the output power.

(5) In some aspects, a repeater for receiving and boosting signals from a plurality of mobile network operators includes a donor antenna for receiving a composite signal that comprises separate signals from two or more of the plurality of mobile network operators, each of the separate signals having an amplitude. The repeater further includes an amplitude equalizer configured to equalize the amplitude of each of the separate signals of the composite signal, and an amplifier configured to boost the composite signal. The repeater further includes a server antenna for transmitting the boosted composite signal with the equalized separate signals.

(6) In other aspects, a method of operating a repeater for receiving and boosting signals from a plurality of mobile network operators includes the steps of receiving, by a donor antenna, a composite signal that comprises separate signals from two or more of the plurality of mobile network operators, each of the separate signals having an amplitude. The method further includes the steps of equalizing the amplitude of each of the separate signals of the composite signal, and boosting the composite signal with equalized separate signals. The method further includes the step of transmitting, by a server antenna, the boosted composite signal with the equalized separate signals.

(7) The details of one or more embodiments are set forth in the accompanying drawings and the description below. Other features and advantages will be apparent from the description and drawings, and from the claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) These and other aspects will now be described in detail with reference to the following drawings.

(2) FIG. 1 depicts a basic structure of a wideband repeater; and

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates a wideband repeater with amplitude equalizer and amplitude equalizer control system, in accordance with implementations of the current subject matter.

(4) Like reference symbols in the various drawings indicate like elements.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(5) This document describes a system and method for operating a repeater with a passband that is wider than the signal of a single mobile network operator. In some implementations, a system includes an Amplitude Equalizer and an Amplitude Equalizer Control System. The Amplitude Equalizer Control System receives information on the input signal strength of wanted signals and controls the Amplitude Equalizer to counteract the difference in input amplitude on the output of the repeater. In some implementations, the input information is generated by cellular modem. In yet other implementations, the Amplitude Equalizer Control System executes an adaptive amplitude equalizer algorithm.

(6) In order to address the unbalanced coverage footprint, a system that automatically equalizes the various wanted signals within the passband is proposed. Such a system can include an adaptive amplitude equalizer processor, executing an adaptive amplitude equalizer algorithm.

(7) As shown in an example illustrated in FIG. 2, an amplitude equalizer **220** is inserted in the signal processing chain of a repeater **200**. The repeater **200** includes a donor antenna **202**, a bandpass filter **204**, and a low-noise amplifier **206** to boost or amplify the filtered signal from bandpass filter **204**. The signal can be a composite signal made up of two or more separate signals, each from a respective mobile network operator. The repeater **200** further includes one or more

power amplifiers **208** to further boost or amplify the composite signal, a second filter **210**, and a server antenna **212** for transmitting the filtered and boosted composite signal and its component separate signals.

(8) In the example shown, an amplitude equalizer **220** is between the low noise amplifier **206** and the power amplifier(s) **208**, but it may also be placed in other positions, or even distributed into multiple amplitude equalization blocks. The repeater **200** also includes an amplitude equalizer control system **222** that configures the amplitude equalizer **220** to counter the imbalance in the input signal so that the output signals from the various mobile network operators are roughly equal.

(9) The amplitude equalizer **220** can be implemented in a number of different ways, including a bank of bandpass filters with variable gain, frequency/amplitude/bandwidth tunable bandpass filters, adaptive filters and other similar devices. The amplitude equalizer control system **222** can receive input signals on a variety of inputs **224** that it can use to determine the configuration of the amplitude equalizer **220**, such as input signal strength of wanted input signals that make up the separate signals of the composite signal to be boosted before being transmitted by the server antenna **212**.

(10) Although a few embodiments have been described in detail above, other modifications are possible. Other embodiments may be within the scope of the following claims.

Claims

1. A repeater for receiving and boosting signals from a plurality of mobile network operators, the repeater comprising a donor antenna for receiving a composite signal that comprises separate signals from two or more of the plurality of mobile network operators, each of the separate signals having an amplitude; an amplitude equalizer configured to equalize the amplitude of each of the separate signals of the composite signal; an amplifier configured to boost the composite signal; and a server antenna for transmitting the boosted composite signal with the equalized separate signals.
2. The repeater in accordance with claim 1, wherein the amplitude equalizer comprises a bank of bandpass filters with variable gain.
3. The repeater in accordance with claim 2, wherein the bank of bandpass filters includes one or more of a frequency, an amplitude, and a bandwidth tunable filter.
4. The repeater in accordance with claim 2, wherein the bank of bandpass filters includes at least one adaptive filter.
5. The repeater in accordance with claim 1, further comprising an amplitude equalizer control system configured for controlling the amplitude equalizer.
6. The repeater in accordance with claim 5, wherein the amplitude equalizer control system includes one or more inputs representing the amplitude of each wanted signal of the separate signals based on an input signal strength of the separate signals.
7. The repeater in accordance with claim 6, wherein the amplitude equalizer control system executes an adaptive amplitude equalizer algorithm based on the one or more inputs to equalize the amplitude of each of the separate signals.
8. The repeater in accordance with claim 1, further comprising an input bandpass filter between the donor antenna and the server antenna and configured to filter the composite signal.
9. The repeater in accordance with claim 1, further comprising a low-noise amplifier configured to amplify the filtered composite signal.
10. The repeater in accordance with claim 9, wherein the amplifier comprises the low-noise amplifier and one or more power amplifiers.
11. A method of operating a repeater for receiving and boosting signals from a plurality of mobile network operators, the method comprising receiving, by a donor antenna, a composite signal that comprises separate signals from two or more of the plurality of mobile network operators, each of the separate signals having an amplitude; equalizing the amplitude of each of the separate signals

- of the composite signal; boosting the composite signal with equalized separate signals; and transmitting, by a server antenna, the boosted composite signal with the equalized separate signals.
12. The method in accordance with claim 11, wherein the equalizing comprises applying a variable gain to each of the separate signals with a bank of bandpass filters.
13. The method in accordance with claim 12, wherein the bank of bandpass filters includes one or more of a frequency, an amplitude, and a bandwidth tunable filter.
14. The method in accordance with claim 12, wherein the bank of bandpass filters includes at least one adaptive filter.
15. The method in accordance with claim 11, further comprising controlling the amplitude equalizer using an amplitude equalizer control system, wherein the amplitude equalizer control system includes one or more inputs representing the amplitude of each wanted signal of the separate signals based on an input signal strength of the separate signals.
16. The method in accordance with claim 15, wherein the input signal strength represents the amplitude of each of the separate signals.
17. The method in accordance with claim 16, wherein the amplitude equalizer control system executes an adaptive amplitude equalizer algorithm based on the one or more inputs for equalizing the amplitude of each of the separate signals.
18. The method in accordance with claim 11, further comprising filtering the composite signal using an input bandpass filter between the donor antenna and the server antenna.
19. The method in accordance with claim 11, further comprising amplifying the filtered composite signal using a low-noise amplifier.
20. The repeater in accordance with claim 19, wherein the boosting comprises using the low-noise amplifier and one or more power amplifiers.
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